

CRICKET – FORMATS, RECORDS & MODERN GREATS (June 2025)

1 · CRICKET AT A GLANCE Cricket is a bat and ball game played internationally in three primary formats:

Format	Overs	Typical Duration	Key Characteristics
Test Match	Unlimited (2 innings)	Up to 5 days	Endurance, technique, tactics
One Day International (ODI)	50 overs/side	~7 hours	Balanced aggression and control
Twenty20 International (T20I)	20 overs/side	~3 hours	Fast paced, power hitting, flair

2 · ALL-TIME RECORD-HOLDERS • Most Test runs – Sachin Tendulkar 15,921 • Most ODI runs – Sachin Tendulkar 18,426 • Most Test wickets – Muttiah Muralitharan 800 • Most ODI wickets – Muttiah Muralitharan 534 • Highest Test team total – Sri Lanka 952&6d (v India, 1997) • Highest ODI total – England 498&4 (v Netherlands, 2022) • Highest individual Test score – Brian Lara 400* (v England, 2004)

3 · FRESH RECORDS & MILESTONES (2024&25) • Nathan Lyon moved into the Test top&eight with 539 wickets. • Virat Kohli crossed 14,000 ODI runs and won the 2025 Champions Trophy. • Pat Cummins (80) and Jasprit Bumrah (77) lead the 2023&25 WTC wicket charts. • The new Anderson&Tendulkar Trophy now replaces the Pataudi Trophy for Eng&Ind Tests.

4 · WHO’S HOT RIGHT NOW – ICC RANKINGS (June&2025) Tests – Batting: Kane Williamson, Joe Root, Steve Smith. Bowling: Pat Cummins, Kagiso Rabada, Jasprit Bumrah. ODIs – Batting: Shubman Gill, Babar Azam, Rohit Sharma. T20Is – Batting: Travis Head, Abhishek Sharma, Tilak Varma.

5 · SEASON LEADERS (Calendar 2025) • Tests – Runs: Usman Khawaja 873 | Wickets: Mitchell Starc 46 • ODIs – Runs: Babar Azam 1,086 | Wickets: Mohammed Shami 27 • T20Is – Runs: Hasan Nawaz 452 | Wickets: Rashid Khan 29

6 · MODERN GREATS Sachin Tendulkar – record Test & ODI runs, first to 100 international 100s. Virat Kohli – fastest to 10k ODI runs, chasing Tendulkar’s century record. Muttiah Muralitharan – unmatched 800 Test & 534 ODI wickets. Babar Azam – only batter to average 50+ concurrently in all three formats.

7 · THE EVOLVING LANDSCAPE Franchise T20 leagues continue to lure stars—Nicholas Pooran retired from WI duty at 29 to focus on global leagues—raising debate about balancing international cricket with lucrative club tournaments.

8 · TAKEAWAYS • Longevity builds records (Tendulkar, Anderson). • Specialists dominate their chosen format (white ball vs Test). • Data is king—real-time stats let fans track greatness as it happens.